Sunitinib 37.5 mg · pancreatic neuroendocrine tumour (NET)

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00327 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Capsules and missed doses

The usual starting dose for this pancreatic NET schedule is 37.5 mg once daily. Follow your label, swallow whole with water and take at the same time each day consistently with or without food. If a dose is missed, do not take an additional dose; take the usual prescribed dose the next day.

STEP 2

Interactions

Avoid grapefruit and St John’s wort. Ask the pharmacist to review every medicine and supplement, including blood thinners, antibiotics and medicines affecting heart rhythm.

STEP 3

Surgery and dental work

Tell your team about planned operations, wounds or invasive dental work. A treatment interruption may be needed for major surgery; the oncology and surgical teams agree when to stop and restart. Ask about a dental assessment.

STEP 4

Storage and supply

Keep capsules in their original labelled packaging, away from children, and follow storage instructions. Return unused medicine to the pharmacy. Bring your current prescription and medicine list to review.

STEP 5

Pregnancy, feeding and fertility

Tell the team about pregnancy, planned pregnancy or breastfeeding before treatment. Ask for the contraception and fertility plan specific to sunitinib, including how long precautions continue after stopping.

STEP 6

Tests and visits

Baseline blood count, kidney/liver, thyroid and blood pressure; urine protein assessment and cardiac tests as indicated. Counts, kidney and liver tests before each cycle; blood pressure (BP) at each attendance; thyroid every 12 weeks. Heart, urine and glucose monitoring are individualised. Scans and tumour markers follow the consultant plan.

Sources: NCCP 00327 v5 · current regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.